

COURTNEY GERVER, Ph.D.

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PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

- Researcher with 10+ years of experience translating qualitative and quantitative data into compelling narratives that inform executive decision-making, product strategy, and innovative thinking
- Skilled at leveraging an always-on employee listening ecosystem to uncover actionable insights, enhance employee experience, and guide business decisions
- Thrives at smoothly navigating ambiguity, competing priorities, fast-paced environments, and developing scalable, culturally sensitive research approaches

SKILLS

Research & Measurement: In-depth interviews, focus groups, ethnographic observation, diary studies, cognitive walkthroughs, thematic analysis, surveys, experimental design, behavioral analytics, A/B testing, longitudinal studies, secondary research, statistical analysis, stimuli development, quantitative and qualitative analysis tools (R, Atlas.ti).

Research Strategy: Research roadmap planning, research strategy development, scalable and culturally sensitive research design integration, stakeholder coordination, multi-project portfolio management, team mentorship and coaching, timeline and milestone tracking, budget oversight

Thought Leadership: Narrative development across audiences, executive presentations, synthesizing findings into actionable insights for business and organizational leaders, cross-functional stakeholder communication, enterprise-wide content series, content marketing, content strategy, executive-ready reports

EXPERIENCE

Consultant, Technology Product Researcher (Voice of the Associate Lead)

Dec. 2024–Present

Nationwide Mutual Insurance Company – Remote, USA

- Lead the Voice of the Associate program, an always-on employee listening ecosystem responsible for translating feedback into actionable insights that influence business decisions impacting 25,000+ associates
- Serve as a trusted expert in rigorous mixed-methods research and advanced analytics, delivering 40+ high-impact projects to ensure data-driven insights are embedded in executive planning, product roadmaps, and operational reviews
- Advise stakeholders across 30+ digital and physical workplace capabilities, partnering with Product, Design, Technology, Talent, and Operations to prioritize investments and strengthen decisions in ambiguous problem spaces
- Transform complex research into compelling narratives via executive shareouts, stakeholder presentations, and a monthly enterprise-wide Voice of the Associate broadcast

Specialist, UX Researcher

Mar. 2022–Dec. 2024

Nationwide Mutual Insurance Company – Remote, USA

- Independently conducted end-to-end qualitative and mixed-methods research representing 1,000+ participants, delivering actionable insights to key stakeholders, Marketing, and company associates through executive-level presentations and internal documentation
- Translated qualitative and quantitative findings into strategic recommendations that connect research to product strategy and business decisions, contributing directly to improved customer retention
- Built cross-functional buy-in with Product and Design teams to implement human-centered qualitative research practices across key emerging technologies, including mobile, generative AI, and blockchain (NFTs)
- Presented research findings beyond core product work to associate communities of practice, extending thought leadership and knowledge-sharing across the organization

Graduate Research Scientist

June 2017–Aug. 2022

The Pennsylvania State University – University Park, PA, USA

- Independently planned, conducted, analyzed, and visualized mixed-methods research from 13,500+ participants via behavioral experiments, surveys, and fMRI across 17 research projects examining the neurobiological basis of cognition
- Landed research narratives across audiences, translating findings into 10 empirical publications, 15 conference presentations, and 3 public community talks for collaborators, project stakeholders, and the general public
- Led and mentored a multi-site teams of 20+ undergraduate researchers, coaching team members on research rigor, methodology, and best practices to drive project excellence and professional growth
- Engineered open-source data processing scripts to optimize lab efficiency and quality control, while contributing to the broader field as an ad hoc peer reviewer evaluating manuscript submissions for methodological and statistical rigor

VOLUNTEER WORK

Communications Committee Social Media Manager

July 2023–Present

Pittsburgh Curling Club

EDUCATION

Ph.D., Cognitive Psychology – The Pennsylvania State University, 2022

M.S., Cognitive Psychology – The Pennsylvania State University, 2019

B.S., Psychology – St. Thomas Aquinas College, 2017

Visiting Scholar – University of Oxford, Summer 2016